REFOCUSING VISION ZERO

Bottom Line

Vision Zero prioritizes human life and counters that traffic crashes are 'accidents' and rather are preventable - with the goal to eliminate traffic fatalities and serious injuries in Denver.

VISION ZERO MISSION

Vision Zero is Denver's mission and strategy to reduce traffic deaths to zero.

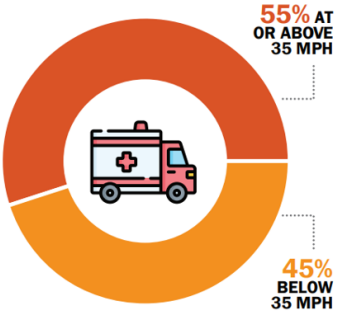
Denver's Vision Zero Action Plan (2023) is guided by the Safe Systems Approach, defining Denver's safety philosophy based on the principles of achieving Vision Zero to eliminate traffic fatalities and serious injuries on our streets. We envision a city where streets are designed and operated to mitigate human mistakes. Denver aspires to a future where every journey is safe and convenient for all.

ENHANCING COMFORT FOR ALL USERS

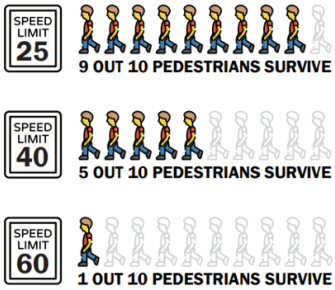
- **Design elements**, including marked crosswalks, curb extensions, pedestrian-activated beacons, and signals, contribute to pedestrian safety and comfort at intersections.
- **Green infrastructure** enhances visual appeal and correlates with reduced speeds, offering buffer space between pedestrians and vehicles to enhance sidewalk comfort.
- **Transit shelters** improve the comfort of waiting for public transit and offer protection from inclement weather.
- **Wider sidewalks and curbspace amenities** create an inviting and comfortable environment for pedestrians.
- **Protected bicycle** lanes provide dedicated space for cyclists, ensuring safer and more enjoyable bike travel separate from vehicle traffic.

SPEED & CRASHES

DENVER DEATHS AND SERIOUS INJURIES:



HIT BY A VEHICLE TRAVELING AT:



High speed is a significant factor in the likelihood of severe injury or death in the event of a crash. In Denver, more than half of all traffic deaths and serious injuries occur on roadways posted at or above 35 mph (DOTI, 2021). High speed is particularly impactful for vulnerable roadway users involved in crashes with vehicles.

Recognizing the link between high speeds and serious crashes, **DOTI evaluates opportunities to combine reduced posted speed limits with streets design changes to effectively reduce travel speeds.**

TOP CRASH CONTRIBUTING FACTORS IN DENVER

Speeding was suspected in 25% of Denver traffic fatalities in 2020 (DPD, 2021).

Substance Use was suspected in 28% of Denver traffic fatalities in 2020 (DPD, 2021)

No Helmet was worn by 59% of motorists who died on Colorado roadways (CDOT, 2010-20)

Distracted Driving is associated with an estimated 10% of traffic fatalities and serious injuries (CDOT, 2019). **

No seatbelt was worn by the occupant in 52% of traffic fatalities in Colorado (CDOT, 2010-2020).

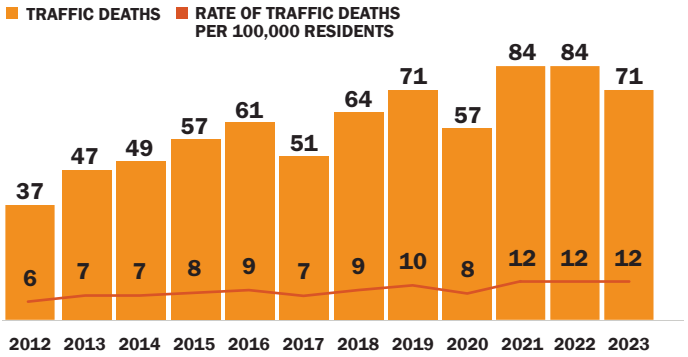
*** Statistic relies on driver self-reporting and likely underestimates total contribution.*

DENVER THE MILE HIGH CITY × VISION ZERO

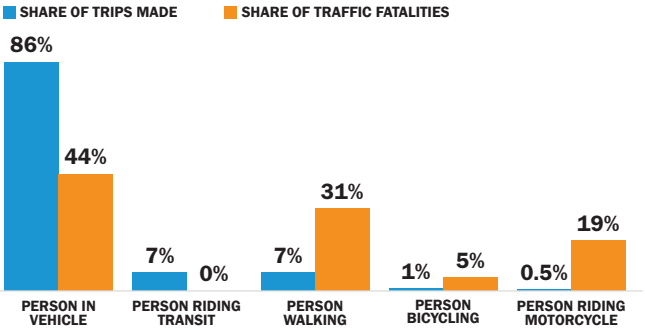
DENVER SAFETY TRENDS

Denver is committed to making streets safe for everyone. Asthe city's population grew over the past 10 years, the **per capita rate** of traffic fatalities increased. Since 2012, Denver averaged approximately 390 serious traffic crashes. Vulnerable roadway users - people walking, riding motorcycles, or bicycles - are heavily overrepresented in fatal traffic crashes.

DENVER TRAFFIC DEATHS AND RATE PER 100,000 PEOPLE



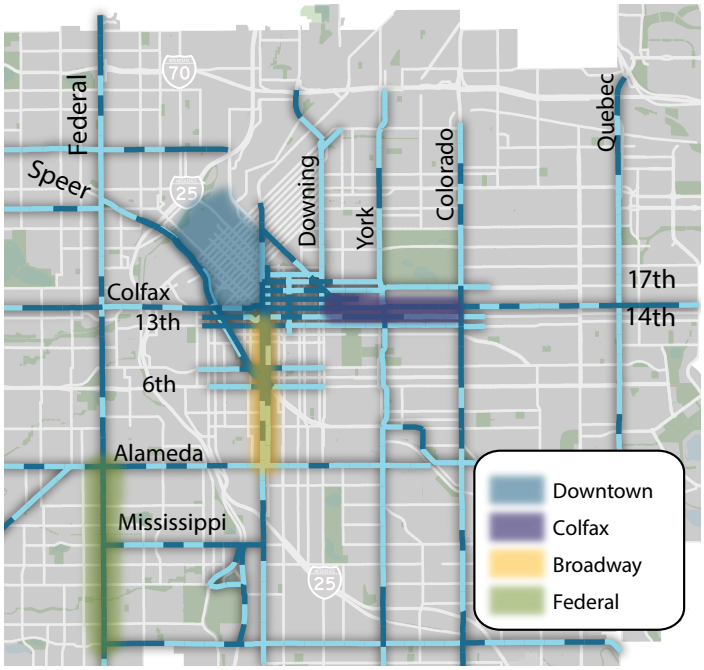
DENVER TRAFFIC DEATHS AND RATE PER 100,000 PEOPLE



VISION ZERO SAFETY FOCUS AREAS

Vision Zero Safety Focus Areas are locations within the city that require immediate safety improvements. These are areas that disproportionately contribute to deaths and serious injuries in the city.

Focus areas are highlighted below, and include Downtown Denver, South Broadway/Lincoln Street Corridor (Colfax Ave to Alameda Ave), South Federal Boulevard Corridor (Alameda Ave to Yale Ave), and East Colfax Avenue Corridor (Park Ave to Colorado Blvd).



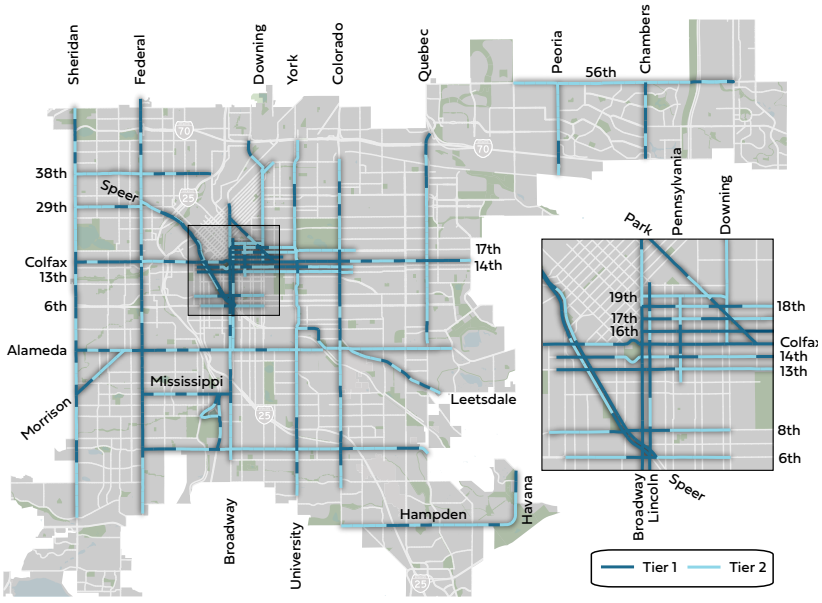
HIGH INJURY NETWORK

Crashes in Denver happen more often on a small proportion of all of Denver's streets. **These streets are defined as the High Injury Network and represent 5% of the city's entire street network, or 161 miles, but accounts for 40% of all traffic related crashes and 50% of serious injuries and deaths.** High Injury Network streets are primarily high-speed, multi-lane arterial roadways.

5% of Denver streets account for 50% of traffic fatalities.

2x more crashes per mile on Denver's High Injury Network roadways.ccount for 50% of traffic fatalities

5x more likely that travelers are seriously injured on Denver's High Injury Network roadways.



While representing only 2% of the city's land area, downtown Denver accounts for 20% of fatal or serious injury crashes

DENVER THE MILE HIGH CITY × VISION ZERO